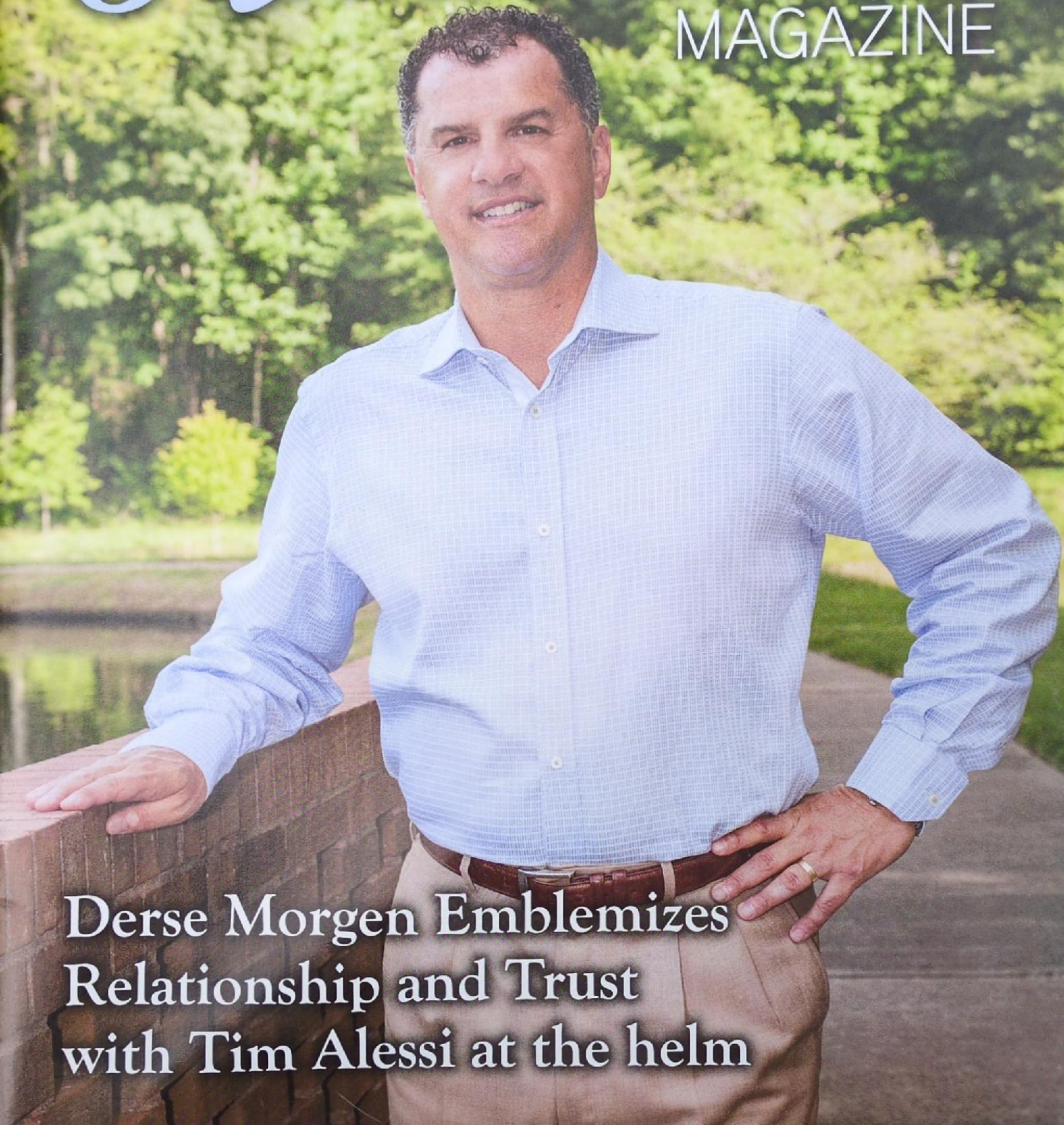


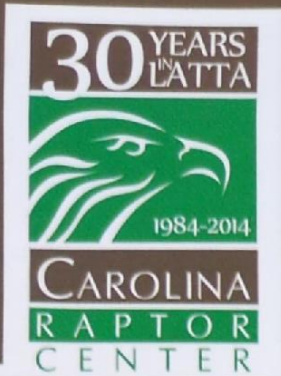
Complimentary • July 2014

Huntersville

MAGAZINE



Derse Morgen Emblemizes
Relationship and Trust
with Tim Alessi at the helm



The Bald Eagle Our National Bird

by Carolina Raptor Center — Michele Houck, Associate Executive Director

Easily identified by their white heads and tail feathers and dark bodies, Bald Eagles are considered majestic birds worthy of their distinction as America's national symbol. Adopted as the image of the United States in 1782, the Bald Eagle almost didn't make the cut — Benjamin Franklin was a strong advocate of the wild turkey.

Unique to North America, Bald Eagles can survive in a variety of climates, limited only by their proximity to water. Their skin is protected by over 7,000 feathers, and their feet are cold-resistant. Part of the sea eagle family, their diet is predominantly fish. Due to its large salmon population, Bald Eagles are most prominent along the northwest coast of North America.

Bald Eagle Facts

Although Bald Eagles prefer fish, they will eat whatever is easiest to find. They can lift about four pounds and will eat almost anything, including carrion (dead or decaying flesh). A proficient hunter, the eagle waits for fish to swim near the surface, approaches in a shallow dive and grabs it with its talons.

Female Bald Eagles often weigh in at 14 pounds with an eight-foot wingspan. Males are smaller, weighing only 10 pounds with a wingspan of six feet. Bald Eagles have been known to live 15-25 years in the wild and even longer in captivity! Bald Eagle pairs mate for life.

Eagles build their nests at the tops of large trees, and generally come back to the same nest each year, enlarging it each nesting season. Their nests can reach sizes of 10 feet across and can weigh up to a half ton! Bald Eagles will typically lay one to three eggs, which will hatch after about 35 days. Chicks are covered in light grey down and eventually grow brown plumage. At about five years of age they develop their signature white head and tail.

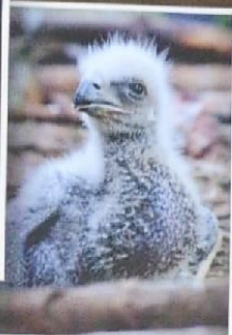
Surviving the Threat of Extinction

When the Bald Eagle was first adopted as the national bird in 1782, there were approximately 100,000 nesting pairs in the country. Early settlers, however, often shot large raptors to eliminate a potential threat to their animals. In 1940, Congress passed the Bald Eagle Protection Act after determining that the species was "threatened with extinction."



Bird Curator Amber Rosintoski and Bald Eagle, Lady CLT, resident raptor at Carolina Raptor Center.

Photo courtesy of Carolina Raptor Center



Photos by Earl Clifford Black

PHOTOS: LEFT A former CRC patient takes flight after being released at McGuire Nuclear Station's Energy Explorium in February. RIGHT 2010 Eaglet Noah hatched at Carolina Raptor Center to parents Savannah and Derek named for fallen soldier in Afghanistan. Released into the wild May 2010.

After World War II, during the heyday of the pesticide DDT, Bald Eagles (and many other birds) faced rapid population declines due to the side effects of the pesticide. Lead poisoning also played a part when Bald Eagles fed on waterfowl containing lead shot.

Since the discovery of the harms of DDT, the Bald Eagle population has recovered. In 1978, the species was designated as "endangered" in the lower 48 states. By 1995, the Bald Eagle had recovered to the point where they were designated as "threatened," and in 2007, the Bald Eagle was officially taken off of the endangered species list and is considered "recovered" by the U.S. Fish and Wildlife Service.

Close to Home

North Carolina Bald Eagles are a great example of the comeback of the Bald Eagle. After the rise of DDT, the Bald Eagle count in NC dropped to zero pairs until 1984! After that, the NC Wildlife Resources Commission began a hacking program at Lake Mattamuskeet, NC's largest natural lake, west of the Pamlico Sound. Since then, more Bald Eagles have returned and continue to breed here. They reside mostly around bodies of water. According to the Carolina Bird Club, Bald Eagles are most easily spotted at Lake Mattamuskeet, catfish ponds near Roper, and Jordan Lake.

Carolina Raptor Center, located inside Latta Plantation Nature Preserve, is also home to many Bald Eagles. CRC has six resident Bald Eagles, including Savannah and Derek, who nest every year and have hatched six eaglets that were later released into the wild. Savannah Eagle even has her own Facebook page: <https://www.facebook.com/SavannahEagle>. In addition, CRC rehabilitates many Bald Eagles in its Jim Arthur Raptor Medical Center. This year alone, the center has treated 10 Bald Eagles, and one will be released with a GPS tracking device in late June. You will be able to follow the bird's migration at www.movebank.org.

Works Cited: <http://www.baldeagleinfo.com>, <http://www.fws.gov>, <http://www.carolinabirdclub.org>

For further information please visit the Carolina Raptor Center's website: <http://www.carolinaraptorcenter.org/>

Are you interested in purchasing income producing commercial real estate?

Call today for a free market overview and investment needs assessment

Specializing in the representation of sellers and purchasers of income producing:

Medical Office • General Office • Retail property



Benjamin E. Bivens
President - Broker

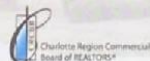
Bivens Investment Group, LLC

Direct: (980) 254-1579

Info@bivensinvestmentgroup.com

www.BivensInvestmentGroup.com

10338 Old Carolina Drive | Charlotte, NC 28214
Licensed Broker in NC, SC, TN



Local businesses are talking...



Huntersville Connection



Join us at Huntersville's largest business networking organization

3rd Tuesday of every month

Like us on Facebook and sign up for email alerts for monthly meeting locations & local business news!

email HuntersvilleConnection@gmail.com to be in the know!